SOLID, LIQUID, AND GAS

"THE STATES OF YOUR WELLBEING MATTER MORE THAN ANYTHING..."

CREATED BY DAVID QUANG PHAM

LOGLINE

A struggling educator must reinvent herself by winning the host role of a beloved children's tv show, only to face the original host's legacy and a public resistant to inclusivity.

INSPIRATION

David mentored neurodivergent actors at children's theatres like Openspot. And one of his theatre professors was on the shortlist to host *Blue's Clues*.

COMPS

chaos of *The Bear* eats fun of *Blue's Clues* eats 4th wall breaks of *Fleabag*

SYNOPSIS

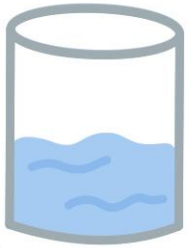
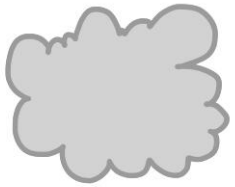
Solid, Liquid, and Gas **is a half-hour dramedy series where the wonder of children's television crashes into the gritty reality of industry rivalry and mental health.**

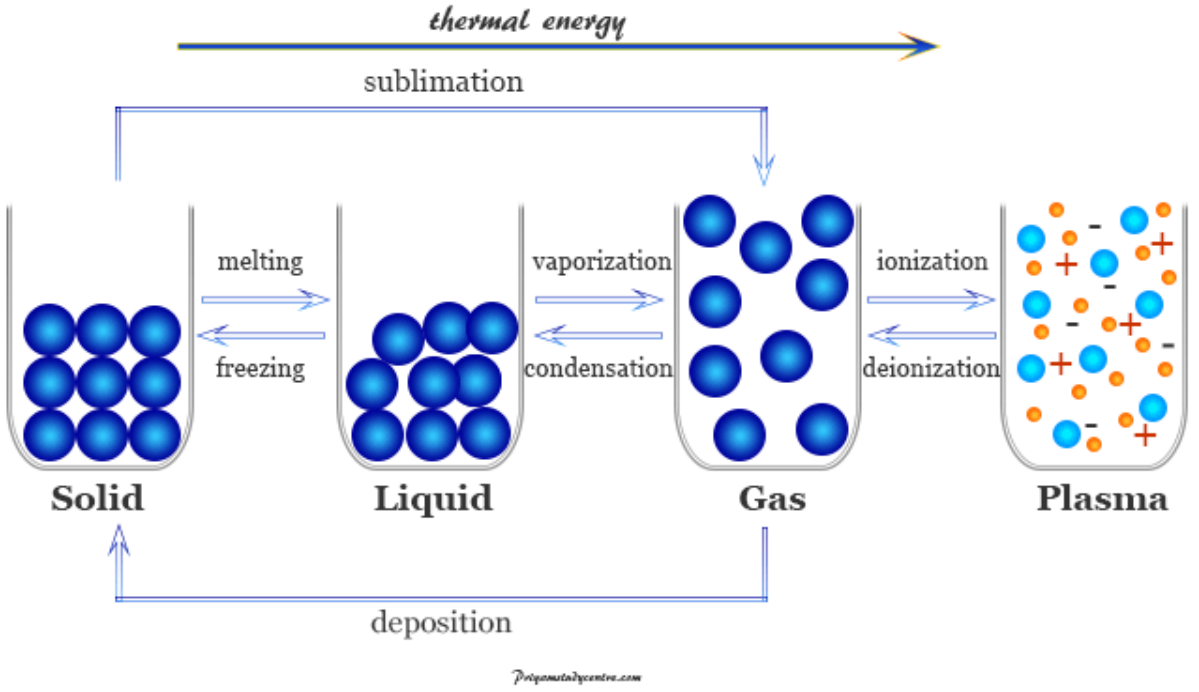
Set in the late 2020s, the story follows Ray Reyes, a Filipina American educator whose theatre career ends in literal fire. Desperate for a fresh start, Ray tries to seize the mantle of *Stardust*, a beloved interactive children's show being revived for a new generation.

To succeed, Ray must navigate the shadow of the first host, Clay, her perfect rival, Ms. Aurora, and a public's distrust of "wokeness." As the pressure mounts, Ray struggles to maintain a ray of sunshine, often erupting fireballs when her mental health is challenged.

Using the states of matter as a metaphor for personal evolution, the series explores how we all must shift between solid, liquid, and gas to survive adulthood.

The Different Phases of Matter

Solid	Liquid	Gas	Plasma
Holds its shape	 Shape conforms to container	 No distinct shape	No distinct shape
Examples: - Salt - Ice - Wood - Phone - Clothes	**Examples:** - Water - Mercury - Blood - Soda - Coffee	**Examples:** - Air - CO_2 - Helium - Oxygen - Propane	**Examples:** - Lightening - Aurora - Neon signs - Sun/stars - Nuclear Fireball

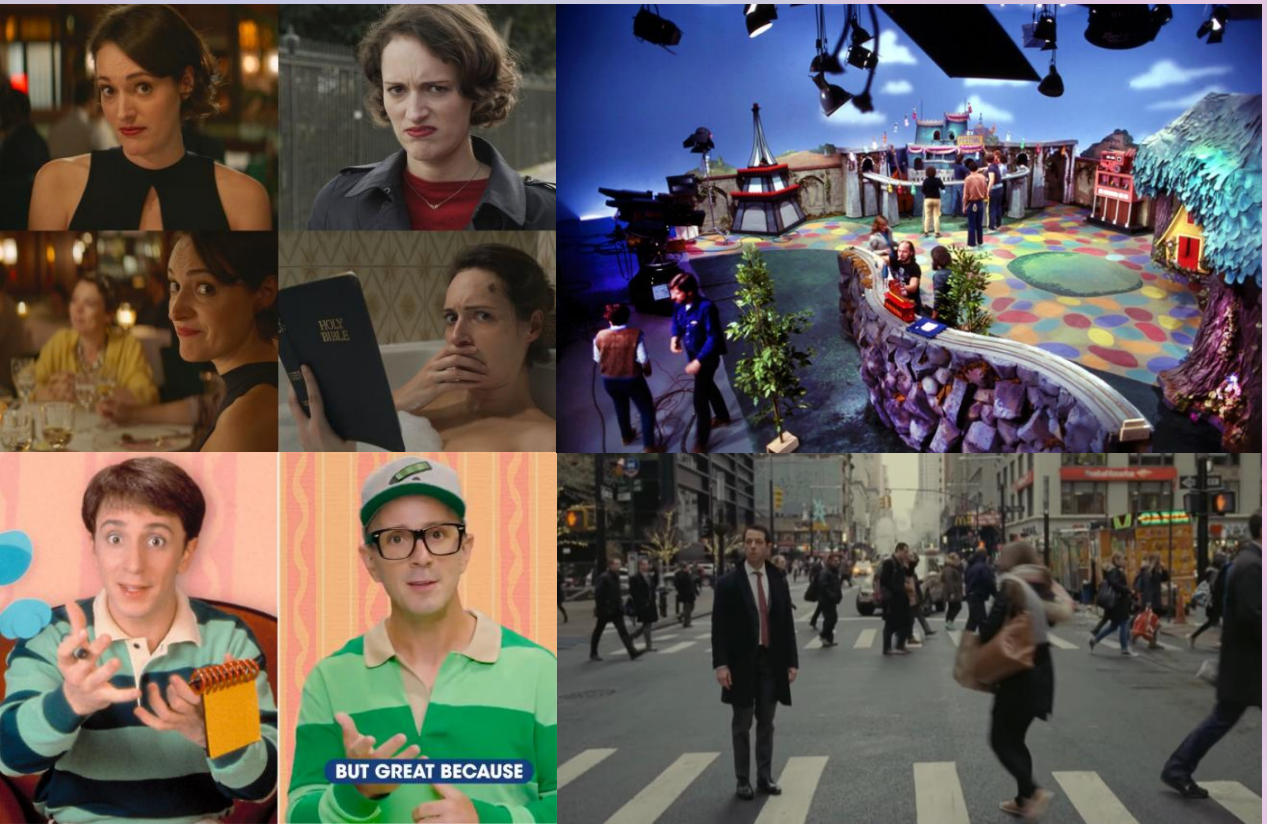


WORLD + TONE

"It's *Blue Clues!* …for adults…" – Carissa Sky

Children's Programming Device:
Fourth wall breaks to ask viewers to respond

Fantastical world of science on Stardust + StarPower! set…
Miserable reality of adulthood for the rest…



SAMPLE SCENE

The waiter is weirded out by Ray and Aurora.

RAY
(to camera; cynically)
Should I commit a crime against humanity or be a model citizen? *Crime or no crime*?

AURORA
Don't mind us, host. We look to our viewers for answers.
(winks at camera)

RAY
You answered crime? Crime, it is!
(to the waiter)
A slice of *pineapple* pizza, please!

RAY - TRINI REYES

Driven by a lifelong passion for science and childhood love for the show *Stardust*, this Filipina American struggling theatre performer fights to be the host of the revival, *StarPower!* She often breaks the fourth wall to speak directly to the camera, sharing cynical thoughts about the world or asking viewers to make a choice. She can speak Tagalog.

CAST: Natalie Malia Figuracion (they/them)

KWAN "SUNSHINE" REYES -plasma-

Ray's younger brother, an astronomy grad student at Michigan State and a member of a neurodivergent theatre. Due to Stardust, he is an astronomy prodigy.

CAST: TBD

MS. AURORA STERLING -plasma-

A world-renowned science educator and the host of *StarPower!* She sings and plays instruments. She is vocal on social issues. Her talking head rivals Ray's.

CAST: TBD

YASMINE 'YLEM' LEM -gas-

The primary animator, designer, and puppeteer of the *Stardust* franchise. She is very animated.

CAST: TBD

BILLY CLAYTON DUBOIS -solid-

The original host of *Stardust*. He left in 2006 due to clinical depression. He often talks to thin air.

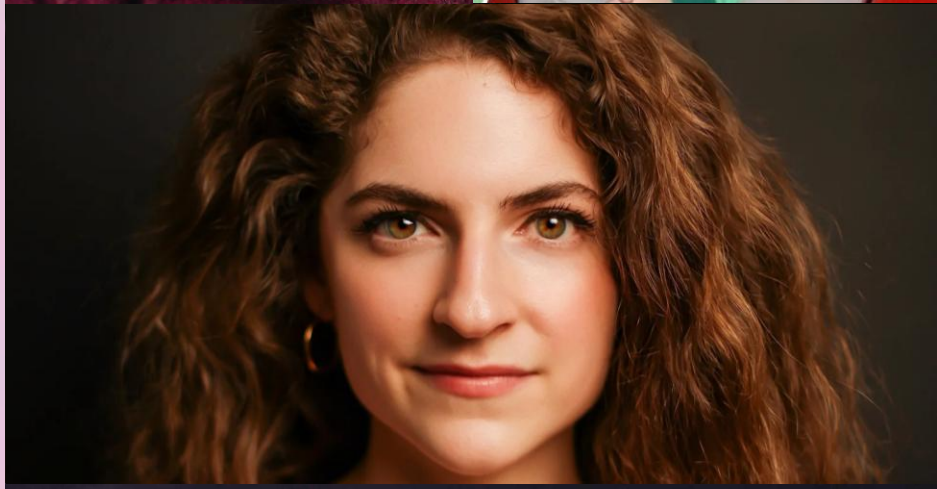
CAST (young): Xavier Soto Burgos (he/him)

CAST (old): TBD

RIVER MATTHEWS -liquid-

The creator of *Stardust* and its revival *StarPower!* She voices Stardust. As a major player in children's programming, she cannot stand Ray.

CAST: Claire Kepple (she/her)



SCHUYLER 'SKYE' PARK -gas-

A co-creator of *Stardust* and voice actor of many of its characters. They are an ally of Ray.

CAST: TBD

STARDUST + STARPOWER (a show within a show) 🌠

A Mac and Cheese Network (MCN) franchise created by River Matthews and Skye Park. It combines concepts from child development and early childhood education with animation and cardboard to help their viewers learn. The series was originally hosted by Billy Clayton Dubois as Clay, who left in 2006 leading to its cancellation until being replaced by Ms. Aurora Sterling as Aurora for the 2026 reboot.

STARDUST (1999–2006) follows Stardust, an animated cosmic mudpuppy, as she leaves glittery trails to help Clay and the viewers navigate a planet they are visiting.

STARPOWER! (2026–2029) follows Stardust's bigger axolotl sister, StarPower, who uses her powers with the help of Stardust, her explorer friends (Aurora and sidekick Ray), and viewers to save planets in trouble.

STARDUST + STARPOWER – Characters (show in a show)

STARDUST (voiced by River Matthews) is a cosmic green mudpuppy who leave glitter for her space explorer friends to find their way through the planets they are visiting.

STARPOWER (voiced by River Matthews) is a cosmic pink axolotl and Stardust's bigger sister who uses her powers to help worlds in trouble.

CLAY (played by Billy Clayton Dubois) is the host of the first show. In the reboot, he since has returned to his home planet, is a rocket scientist, and appears as a recurring character.

AURORA (played by Ms. Aurora) is the host of the revival series *StarPower!* and the second host of the franchise. She is Clay's younger cousin and a talented musician.

RAY (played by Trini Reyes) is Aurora's courageous sidekick of the revival series. She often gets sent to scout inconvenient places. She becomes the third host of the franchise.

ROCKET (voiced by Skye Park) is a cheerful green-and-white ship who transports Stardust and her friends to distant worlds.

TELESCOPE (voiced by Skye Park) is an insightful telescope.

PILOT: “INNER CHILD” PLOT SUMMARY - 30 Minutes

In 2001, four-year-old Ray is a fan of *Stardust*, an educational show hosted by Clay. In the coming years, Ray uses the show’s lessons to help her little brother Kwan heal.

By 2025, Ray’s theatre career ends in disaster upon triggering a fire that destroys a production’s puppet cast. Blacklisted and facing eviction, she is moved by a recent viral video from Clay, returning to encourage former viewers to keep looking up.

Seeking a fresh start, Ray visits Kwan at his college, where she learns that *Stardust*'s creator, River Matthews, is appearing at an arts fair. There, Ray attempts to pitch herself as a collaborator, but River dismisses her.

Ray soon meets the co-creator, Skye Park, who invites her to dinner with River. At dinner, Ray finds out the *Stardust* revival *StarPower!* has been greenlit. But the creators plan to bypass auditions and hire Ray’s polished rival, Ms. Aurora.

Kwan finds his childhood letter from Clay with Clay’s address and drives Ray to his apartment in Brooklyn. When Ray meets her childhood hero and asks for his help to save Stardust, a disheveled Clay looks into the camera and asks, "Do I look like I care?"

SEASON 1 ARC: SOLID - 13 EPISODES

Rise & Rivalry

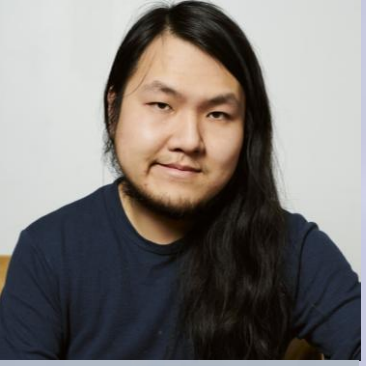
After a disastrous ending to her career in theatre, Ray tracks down the original host Clay for mentorship to audition for the *Stardust* revival. He cameos in her audition tape, leading the network to consider Ray. Her longtime rival Ms. Aurora wins the lead; Ray is hired as a writer's assistant but ends up a sidekick role.

Conflict & Crisis

Ray's improvisation clashes with Aurora's rehearsed style, leading to disastrous test audience feedback. She also objects to Aurora's political activism, leading to a neutral stance that creates tension between them. To prove her bravery, Ray guest stars on a conservative platform, resulting in a public backlash and her firing.

Redemption & Mantle

Aurora leverages her fame to demand Ray's return, forcing the network to rehire her. Aurora quits for a new science show; Ray finally steps up as the solo lead host. Ray is unaware that Clay is plotting to reclaim his spot.



Showrunner + Composer: DAVID QUANG PHAM

An award-winning songwriter, theatre and filmmaker who personifies science to explore social issues and the human condition. 2025 highlights include the world premiere of his musicals *Turnover: A New Leaf* and *Chemicals in the Water*, alongside film fellowships with Cinephila and Kellogg's Foundation. He is an astrophysics and theatre graduate from Michigan State.

Producer: SANNETTE GAIA

Sannette Gaia is an American producer and director. Hailing from Salem, OR, her love for visual and performing arts began at an early age. She began performing at the age of 11 on stage, subsequently writing local award-winning plays. [IMDB]

Director: TBD

Film Team:

Director of Photography: TBD
Assistant Director: TBD
Sound Recordist: TBD
Production Coordinator: LEE PETROLL

Art Team:

Animation: LuckyJoy Studio -CEO BEMA COULIBALY
Character Design: (Tent: JAYDE PANG)
Animators: BEMA COULIBALY,
Storyboard: TBD

WHY NOW? Rebuilding Trust through Science and Story

We're living in an era of scientific skepticism and distrust in education. For the *Blue's Clues* generation, host Steve Burns shared puzzles we solved through kindness and listening.

Today, the same generation is grappling with an anti-truth reality and mental health crises. *Solid, Liquid, and Gas* is a response to this, by using children's programming devices to dismantle complexities of adulthood. It asks: **How do we stay solid when the world is evaporating around us?**

ACCOLADES 🏆

- 2026 Digital Dramaturgy Finalist

DEVELOPMENT

Mar '26 | Playwrights Horizon (Workshop)

'25 – ongoing | ScripTank (Lab)

WHAT WE NEED

Solid, Liquid, and Gas is in active development. We're seeking partners to fund the pilot production of "Inner Child," serving as the proof-of-concept for our first season.

The Ask: $26,100 (Budget)

Production & Live-Action Talent (60%)
2D Puppet Animation (20%)
Locations: Brooklyn & Planetarium (15%)
Contingency (5%)

The Momentum

★ Producer Sannette Gaia and most key cast members are locked
★ Pilot script, 4/13 episodes, Stardust scripts, and Series Bible are complete

The Goal

It's not just a show; we're building a mental health kit for the generations who grew up on children's programming and are now struggling.

PAST WORK

Short Films

Buyer's Remorse:
A Couch With Personality

Director: Caitlin Mayernik;
Screenwriter: David

Music Videos

"Life in NYC"
by Marilyn Chau

Director: Kenneth Ruan;
Producer: David

Animations

Reimmy the Cockroach
and his Squirrel Friend

Director: Bema Coulibaly;
Cowriter: David

Proshots

Musical Reel

Producer/
Writer/DP:
David

Let's Create the Universe Together

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Special Thanks to…

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Deric McNish
Tah-Janay Shayoñe
Carissa Sky

SOLID, LIQUID, AND GAS

"PROTECT THE STATES OF OUR WELLBEINGS.
LET'S MAKE THEM MATTER!"

"Thank you for your spacetime"
- Stardust + StarPower